

CHAPTER 11 / SHARING THE ROAD

As a driver, you must learn to safely share the road with a variety of other users. These include, but are not limited to: large vehicles, motorcycles, mopeds, pedestrians, bicyclists, in-line skaters, roller skaters, skateboarders, slow moving vehicles, non-motorized scooters and horseback riders. You should know how to safely manage the problems they can present and understand the special rules they must obey.

PEDESTRIANS

Pedestrians are at high risk in traffic. The law requires you to be extra careful to avoid a collision with them.

Look out for children, near schools, bus stops, playgrounds, parks and ice cream trucks.

When you back up your car or truck, look through your back window for pedestrians. Do not rely only on mirrors when children are near. Before you back into a driveway, or out of it, get out of the vehicle and check behind your vehicle.

Pedestrians are supposed to walk on the side of the road and face the traffic in the lane nearest them. When you make a right turn, watch for those pedestrians on your right. When you make a left turn, watch for pedestrians on the other side of the road on your left.

A special right-of-way law allows blind pedestrians to go across the road with a guide dog or a white or metal cane. You must always give them the right-of-way when they are trying to cross at a marked or unmarked crosswalk even if the traffic signals or other right-of-way rules are not in their favor.

Remember to move your eyes as you drive. Look to either side every few seconds to help you spot pedestrians near or approaching the roadway.

The law requires pedestrians to:

- Obey traffic and pedestrian signals, traffic officers and official signs.
- Use the sidewalk when available or face traffic as they walk, as far from the near traffic lane as possible.
- Never stand in the road to hitchhike or conduct business with motorists.

Tips for Drivers:

- Be alert: Always watch for pedestrians.
- Make sure the pedestrian sees you!
- Scan the road and the sides of the road ahead for pedestrians.
- Do not expect a pedestrian to always follow the rules of the road and expect that a pedestrian may be entering the roadway at anytime, anywhere, including outside of crosswalks. Expect the unexpected.
- Before making a turn, look in all directions for pedestrians crossing. Then look again. Particularly, left turns can be a very dangerous maneuver for a motor vehicle driver.
- For example, > 35% of the NYC pedestrian injury crashes occur when a driver is attempting to make a left turn.
- Don't drive after consuming alcohol or other drugs, or when you are fatigued.
- Do not use your cell phone or text while driving.
- Do not use portable electronic devices, headphones or do any other activity that will distract you.